



THE IRON WOLVES ORGANIZATION

Official Guild Charter & Field Guide



| *"The strength of the pack is the strength of all."*

Guild Master: Tharion Voss

Berdusk & the Sword Coast

A Word from the Guild Master

| *What you hold in your hands is not merely a document of rules and ranks. It is a statement of purpose — and a reminder of why the Iron Wolves exist at all.*

I did not found this organization on a whim. The road to Berdusk is littered with the graves of those who died because no one came in time — merchants, families, pilgrims who believed the world was safer than it was. I was a captain of the city guard when I arrived too late to save one such caravan. I will not speak of what I found there. I will only say that I did not sleep well for a long time afterward.

When I left my post, I carried two things with me: my sword, and a history. Somewhere in the vaults of Berdusk's libraries I had discovered scattered records of an organization that once walked these same roads — the Independent Wanderers Organization, the IWO. Their story is told in greater detail later in this charter. But their creed, pieced together from those faded records, became the foundation of everything you see before you today.

The Wanderers taught me something important: you do not have to swear to a crown to serve the people. You do not have to be a hero to do heroic things. You only have to show up.

That is what the Iron Wolves do. We show up.

Welcome to the pack.

— Tharion Voss, Guild Master
Iron Wolves Organization, Berdusk

Origins of the Organization

The Iron Wolves Organization was founded in the city of Berdusk by Tharion Voss, a former captain of the city guard, after a merchant caravan was slaughtered on the Coast Way within a day's ride of the city walls. The perpetrators were never brought to justice. The law, it seemed, stopped at the city gates.

Tharion assembled a small company of trusted companions — scouts, blades, and former soldiers who shared his conviction that the roads could not be left unguarded. They took the name Iron Wolves from the old wilderness saying: iron survives the forge, and the wolf survives the winter. Together, nothing can break them.

In the years since its founding, the Iron Wolves have grown from that small band into a respected guild operating across the western Sword Coast. They escort caravans, investigate threats to settlements, and respond when no one else will.

The Creed

"The strength of the pack is the strength of all. We do not serve crowns. We do not chase glory. We show up, we stand firm, and we bring everyone home."

† Adapted from a fragment recovered from the records of the Independent Wanderers Organization. See: Those Who Came Before.

The Symbol

Every member of the Iron Wolves is given a wolf-headed pendant upon joining the organization. The pendant is cast in iron — deliberately unadorned. Tharion has always insisted it not be made of silver or gold. "We are not nobility," he has said. "We are wolves. Iron endures."

The pendant serves as identification, as a bond of trust between members, and as a reminder of the creed. To lose it in the field is considered deeply unfortunate. To give it away freely to someone who has not earned it is considered an insult to the pack.

Guild Master Voss carries his own pendant always — the same iron, the same weight, no different from those given to the newest recruit.

Guild Master: Tharion Voss

Tharion Voss is a weathered half-elf of middle years, his once-dark hair now streaked through with grey. A long scar runs from his left cheekbone to his jaw — the legacy of a wyvern ambush near Elturel during the organization's early days. He does not speak of it often. Those who ask are usually told simply: "I was faster than the wyvern. Barely."

His manner is direct without being unkind. He commands a room not through raised voices but through the quality of his attention — when Tharion listens, people feel heard. When he speaks, people believe him. He built the Iron Wolves on that quality as much as on any tactical ability.

He is known to spend his nights in the guild's war room, poring over maps by candlelight long after the rest of the organization has retired. Members who have passed his door in the small hours report the same sight every time: the Guild Master bent over a map, the wolf pendant in one hand, a cold cup of tea in the other.

Known History

- Former captain of the Berdusk city guard
- Founded the Iron Wolves Organization following a massacre on the Coast Way
- Survived a wyvern ambush near Elturel — the scar is a point of quiet pride
- Has refused three separate offers of formal commission from the Lords of Waterdeep
- Studied the records of the Independent Wanderers Organization extensively prior to the Iron Wolves' founding

On the matter of the IWO, Tharion has said this: "They were not perfect. They disagreed, they struggled, some of them failed in ways that cost them everything. But they showed up for one another and for the people around them. That is all I have ever asked of this organization — and all I ever will."

Guild Services & Rates

The Iron Wolves are not a charity. The organization operates on contracts — clear agreements between client and guild that outline the service rendered, the duration, and the fee. Tharion Voss has always believed that fair pay for honest work is a form of respect, both to the client and to the guild members who put their lives on the line to fulfill it.

All contracts are negotiated through the Guild Master or a designated senior member. No Iron Wolf operates independently for pay without guild authorization — doing so is grounds for expulsion.

Service	Rate & Notes
Standard Caravan Escort	150 gp per leg of journey. Covers a full party of Iron Wolves for one continuous route between two settlements.
Extended Escort (Multi-leg)	120 gp per leg for contracts covering three or more legs, negotiated in advance. Lodging and provisions provided by client.
Settlement Defense	200 gp per week. Minimum two-week contract. Includes perimeter assessment and threat report at contract's end.
Missing Persons Investigation	80 gp retainer + 40 gp per day in the field. Capped at 30 days without renegotiation.
Threat Assessment & Scout	60 gp per day. Written report delivered within 48 hours of field return. No engagement with hostile forces included.
Monster Clearance (Single Site)	Starting at 100 gp. Final rate determined by size of site and nature of threat. Hazard premium applies for undead, fiends, or draconic creatures.
Conflict Resolution	50 gp per party, per session. The Iron Wolves facilitate — they do not arbitrate. Both parties must agree in writing before service begins.
Emergency Response	Double standard rate. Payment due before deployment.
Training & Consultation	30 gp per day per trainer. Town militia training packages available. Inquire with Guild Master.

A note on payment: the Iron Wolves accept gold, trade goods at fair market value, and in rare circumstances, negotiated services in kind. They do not accept promissory notes from parties they have not worked with before.

† Emergency Response contracts are reserved for situations of genuine crisis. Clients who invoke emergency rates for non-emergency situations will be charged double and declined future contracts.

Known Operations & Honors

The Iron Wolves do not keep public records of every contract — clients deserve discretion. What follows are operations of sufficient significance that they have passed into the organization's institutional memory, either through their outcome, their difficulty, or the lessons they taught.

The Coast Way Massacre

The event that precipitated the founding of the Iron Wolves. A merchant caravan of eleven wagons was attacked and destroyed on the Coast Way within a day's ride of Berdusk. Forty-three people died. The perpetrators were never identified. Tharion Voss, then a captain of the city guard, arrived six hours too late. He resigned his commission within a fortnight.

The Iron Wolves have never formally accepted a contract they believe might be related to this attack. The file remains open.

The Conyberry Blockade

The village of Conyberry had been effectively blockaded by a mercenary company calling themselves the Red Ledger, who demanded tribute payments the village could not sustain. The Iron Wolves were contracted by a consortium of Conyberry farmers to resolve the situation.

The Red Ledger was dispersed in a single night engagement. Three Iron Wolves were wounded; none were lost. The village resumed normal operations within a week. This operation is cited internally as a clear statement of what the Iron Wolves stand for.

The Red Larch Road Disappearances

Seventeen travelers vanished on the road between Red Larch and Beregost over the course of four months. Local authorities attributed the losses to bandits. The Iron Wolves, contracted by the Merchants' League of Beregost, determined within two weeks that the actual cause was a nest of will-o'-wisps that had migrated out of the Mere of Dead Men into an abandoned keep along the road.

The nest was cleared. The road was declared safe. The Iron Wolves submitted a written report recommending that the keep be demolished, as it presented an ongoing risk. The recommendation was ignored. The Iron Wolves declined to comment publicly on this outcome.

The Wyvern Ambush near Elturel

A routine escort contract. The caravan was ambushed at dusk by a pair of wyverns in the hill country south of Elturel. The Iron Wolves held the line. One wyvern was killed; the other fled. The caravan reached its destination with no civilian casualties.

Tharion Voss sustained the wound that left the scar on his left cheek. He refused to leave the field until the caravan was safe. This is considered the standard.

The Daggerford Border Dispute

A dispute over grazing rights between two noble families in the farmlands surrounding Daggerford had escalated to the point of hired blades and threatened open conflict. Both families independently contracted the Iron Wolves for protection — neither aware the other had done the same.

Upon discovering the situation, Tharion convened both parties in a neutral location and facilitated a written agreement between them. Neither family went home entirely happy. Both went home alive. The Iron Wolves charged both parties the standard conflict resolution rate.

† This operation was directly responsible for the addition of Conflict Resolution to the Iron Wolves' standard rate schedule, where it has remained ever since.

The Long Winter Contract — Triboar

An unusually severe winter cut off several settlements in the Triboar region from resupply for eleven weeks. The Iron Wolves ran four supply convoys through conditions that most professional haulers refused. Two wagons were lost to avalanche. No lives were lost.

Guild Master Voss has described this operation as one of the Iron Wolves' finest hours. The organization considers it a reminder of why the work matters.

Joining the Pack

The Iron Wolves do not recruit at tavern boards or city gates. They do not post notices seeking adventurers of all classes and backgrounds. New members come to the organization through recommendation, reputation, or the kind of circumstance that reveals a person's character without them realizing they are being observed.

Tharion Voss has turned away skilled warriors and capable spellcasters because he did not trust them. He has accepted people of unremarkable ability who possessed, in his words, "the right kind of stubbornness." The Iron Wolves are not looking for heroes. They are looking for people who can be relied upon.

The Process

- A prospective member is introduced to the organization by an existing member in good standing, or approaches the Guild Master directly with a letter of reference from a known party.

- The Guild Master conducts an interview. There are no standard questions. Tharion tends to know what he is looking for within the first ten minutes; the rest of the conversation is for the prospective member's benefit.
- If accepted, the prospective member enters a probationary period of no less than three contracts. During this time they are considered an Associate — they carry the organization's authority in the field but are not yet full members.
- At the conclusion of the probationary period, the Guild Master and any senior members who worked alongside the Associate make a determination. Tharion has final say.
- Full members receive the wolf-headed pendant in a brief ceremony that Tharion insists on conducting personally. He considers it the most important thing he does.

What the Iron Wolves Look For

- Reliability — showing up when you said you would, doing what you said you would do
- Steadiness under pressure — not recklessness, not cowardice, but the ability to think when things go wrong
- Loyalty to the pack — an Iron Wolf does not leave a colleague behind
- Honesty — with the Guild Master, with clients, and with themselves
- The capacity to follow orders and the wisdom to know when not to

What the Iron Wolves Do Not Accept

- Members who work private contracts without guild authorization
- Members who bring their personal vendettas into guild operations
- Members who lie to the Guild Master — once
- Members who harm civilians under any circumstances, for any reason

Expulsion from the Iron Wolves is rare. When it happens, the expelled member returns their pendant. Tharion collects it himself. He does not make a speech. The pendant goes into a locked box in the war room. There are currently three pendants in that box. Tharion does not discuss them.

Rumors & Warnings from the Road

The following intelligence has been gathered by Iron Wolves members operating across the Sword Coast in recent months. It is presented without editorial comment. Members operating in

affected areas should exercise appropriate caution and report any additional information to the Guild Master upon return.

The Dragon Sightings

Multiple sources, independently and without apparent coordination, have reported winged shapes in the sky over the inland trade routes. Descriptions vary: some say black, some say blue, one credible witness near the Greenfields described something much larger that did not match any chromatic dragon of known size. Tharion has been quietly gathering these reports for some time. He has not shared his conclusions.

"We have seen this kind of thing before. The difference is that before, we saw one. Now we are hearing of many. That means something." — T.V.

The Cult Activity

Travelers on the eastern roads have reported unusual gatherings at night — torches in formations, robed figures, chanting carried on the wind. Three separate caravans have reported losing a member of their party between campsites with no explanation. No bodies have been recovered. No demands have been made. The absence of demands is what concerns the Iron Wolves most.

Members are advised not to travel the eastern roads alone and to report any unusual symbols or suspicious gatherings immediately.

The Hired Blades

There are more mercenary companies on the roads than there were a year ago. Most are legitimate; some are not. Members are cautioned to verify the credentials of any armed party claiming to offer escort services in the Iron Wolves' operational area — there have been two reports of companies using falsified guild marks to gain client trust before robbing them.

The Iron Wolves' authentic mark is the wolf-headed pendant worn by all full members. Clients may always ask to see it.

The Road to Elturel

The road between the Greenfields and Elturel has seen a significant increase in traffic, much of it unusual. Refugees, though from where is unclear. Merchants moving goods without paperwork. Armed parties moving fast and without wagons. Elturel itself is reported to be tense. Iron Wolves operating in the area are advised to be thoughtful about which conversations they enter and which they quietly walk away from.

The Missing Patrol

An Iron Wolves patrol of two members was dispatched eight weeks ago to investigate reports of bandit activity on the road between Red Larch and Triboar. They have not reported in. A search found their campsite intact, their horses grazing nearby, and no sign of struggle. The investigation is ongoing. Members with any information are asked to bring it to the Guild Master directly.

This report is included here because the Iron Wolves believe in transparency with their members. We do not know what happened. We intend to find out.

Those Who Came Before: The Independent Wanderers Organization

The Iron Wolves did not emerge from nothing. Tharion Voss has always been explicit about this. Before the Iron Wolves, there was another organization — older, less formal, and in many ways more remarkable for surviving as long as it did.

The Independent Wanderers Organization — known simply as the IWO, or to those who knew its members, as the Wanderers — was founded in an age so distant that its origins have passed from history into something closer to legend. The world was different then. The roads were different. The threats were different. And yet the need that gave rise to the Wanderers was precisely the same need that gave rise to the Iron Wolves: the roads were dangerous, and no one was coming.

The Wanderers' most celebrated era — what historians call their Golden Age — was defined by a remarkable collection of individuals who seemed, against all odds, to work. Not always smoothly. Not always without cost. But they worked.

"Unlike traditional guilds, the organization never swore itself to a kingdom, church, or ruler. That independence became both its greatest strength and the reason it earned its name."

What follows are entries from what appears to be a series of memorial plaques — discovered by later adventurers who stumbled upon what may have been a Wanderers chapter house, long abandoned, in a location that even the most thorough of scholars has been unable to definitively identify. The plaques are reproduced here as faithfully as the surviving records allow.

Sir Anders — Paladin

A noble and honorable Paladin of Bahamut. Wielder of the hammer Storm's Herald. Known for his generosity and his faithfulness to his friends. One of the founders of the revived Independent Wanderers Organization. His exploits include the clearing of the Everforge of Kobolds, the defense of Skalington, the cleansing of the Bronze Shrine and the saving of the dragon Lhammaruntosz, and the Battle of Everforge to end the Dwarven Inquisition.

Tanklynn — Cleric, Dwarf

A headstrong and pious dwarf. Though he led the Dwarven Inquisition and fought against his former allies, he will still be honored in these halls. He was part of the founding of the Independent Wanderers Organization, assisted in the cleansing of the Everforge, the defense of Skalington against the bandit group known as the Calamity, and fought honorably for the Dwarven Army of Mauradin.

Prim — Rogue, Halfling

A skillful halfling who was as deadly as she was innocent-looking. Though she joined the Independent Wanderers Organization after its revival, she was a valued member of the group. She always followed her heart and could not be swayed from her morals. The ones that crossed her did not live long enough to do so twice. She was taken from us sooner than we wanted. She has surely found victory on the other side of the veil.

Lily — Ranger

A soft-spoken ranger who fell ill to a mysterious sleeping sickness. The best minds of the IWO could not wake her, but she was cared for until her passing many decades later. She had the most accurate shot while aiming at Goliath ankles.

Rom Barow — Artificer, Rock Gnome

An eccentric and chaotic Rock Gnome who joined the IWO at a later date but proved invaluable to the group. A constant tinkerer. He once launched a boulder directly at the head of an ancient dragon in the Demonblood Highlands. He was also the co-creator of the shrinking and enlarging catapulted boulder.

Graybeard — Fighter, Dwarf

A stoic and devoted dwarf who was one of the few that did not side with Tanklynn in the Dwarven Inquisition. He was one of the original founders of the IWO and stayed loyal to the group until the end. He went on a quest to find a way to stop the group of dwarves who were attempting to end the use of magic. During the Battle of Everforge, he arrived in time to save multiple lives.

Laraunt — Wizard, Half-Elf

An ambitious half-elf with an unquenchable thirst for the arcane arts. Laraunt was one of the founding members of the revitalized IWO and fought against the dwarves in the Dwarven Inquisition. He was known to use any source of power available to further the goals of the IWO — or his own desires.

Offick — Barbarian, Goliath

A powerful and relentless Goliath who was the muscle of the IWO. Warchief Offick was a founding member of the IWO and a leader of his tribe of fellow Goliaths. Known for his stunning acts of strength and his legendary boots of flying — enemies of his never knew which direction their deaths from his mighty axe would come from.

[†] The Offic name persists to this day, carried by at least two individuals known to be operating in the current era. Whether there is a family connection to Warchief Offick has not been established. It has also not been ruled out.

Cricket — Druid, Gnome

A chipper gnome who wielded the power of the wilds. Cricket was a founding member of the IWO and was known to show great compassion to animals great and small. Her enemies feared the force of nature if they ever crossed her. She led her coven of druids in the final battle against the Dwarven Inquisition by providing support through the air, ground, and sea.

Eina — Monk, Halfling

A quick-witted and short-tempered halfling known for her cutting remarks and powerful fists. Eina joined the IWO after saving the town of Phandalin and was a major part of the battle against the Dwarven Inquisition. She was never afraid to speak up against any injustice she witnessed, and was quick to right any wrong through words — or the broken bones of her enemies.

Thaddeus — Cleric, Dwarf

A devout dwarf of Uula who always followed his goddess in what was right. One of the saviors of Phandalin who later joined with the IWO in some of their adventures. During the Dwarven Inquisition, Thaddeus was torn between his friends, his race, and his goddess. Though he left the IWO to join the Dwarven Inquisition, the good he did will still be honored in these halls.

Thuban — Sorcerer, Human

A curious human who straddled the line between life and death. He joined the IWO at a later time but proved to be a valuable hero for the cause. Thuban came from the distant land of Azeroth, where he had a hand in putting down the fire elemental Ragnoros, the black dragon Netharios, closing the gates of Ahn'Quiraj, and bringing an end to the machinations of the lich Kel'Thuzard in his floating ziggurat Naxxaramas.

A Note in Closing

The Wanderers are gone. Their chapter houses are empty. Their founding documents, if they ever existed in this age, have not been found. What remains are fragments — the plaques above, a handful of references in older records, a creed that survived because someone wrote it down.

The Iron Wolves are not the IWO. We are not trying to be. We are something new, built on a different road, in a different time, for different people.

But we carry the same belief they carried: that showing up matters. That the road does not have to be as dangerous as it is. That ordinary people can do extraordinary things when they stand together.

The strength of the pack is the strength of all.

— T.V.

This document was compiled under the authority of Guild Master Tharion Voss for distribution to active members and contracted clients of the Iron Wolves Organization. It is not intended for public circulation. If you have received this document and are not affiliated with the Iron Wolves, we would very much like to speak with you.
